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ADVOCACY · LEGACY · BRANDING

UNMUTED · PARTICIPANT WORKSHEET

# Name the Story *You Carry*



*A reflective practice for identifying the narratives  
that shape us — and the impact they can have when  
shared with intention.*

*Storytelling as a Tool for Stigma Shattering & System Shifting*

#SHATTERTHESTIGMA · SECTION 5 · PARTICIPANT REFLECTION

BEGIN HERE

# Before You *Begin*

***This is a reflection tool — not a disclosure tool.***

You are not required to share anything you write. You choose what stays private and what becomes public. This worksheet exists to help you name what you already know — quietly, privately, and in your own time.

*Take a breath. Set your own pace. Honor your boundaries.*

**BREATHE IN****SETTLE****BREATHE OUT**

## ***How to Use This Worksheet***

- ◆ Move through the prompts slowly
- ◆ Write what feels true
- ◆ Skip anything that feels too tender
- ◆ Return later if needed
- ◆ There are no wrong answers
- ◆ Let silence be part of the process

1

## THE STORY YOU CARRY

# What is one story you carry *that has shaped you?*

*Some stories live quietly in the body long before they find words. This is where you begin to name yours.*

THIS COULD BE

A moment

A challenge

A lesson

A turning point

A truth you learned the hard way

A system you had to navigate

A role you had to grow into

*Write freely. No editing. No polishing. Just truth.*

SPACE FOR WRITING

#SHATTERTHESTIGMA

2

## WHAT THIS STORY TAUGHT YOU

What did this experience *teach you* about yourself, others, or the world?

*Lived experience is a curriculum. Let yourself be the student of your own life.*

CONSIDER

Strength

Identity

Culture

Resilience

Boundaries

Systems

Stigma

Support

*What wisdom did this story leave with you?*

SPACE FOR WRITING

## 3

## IDENTITY + CONTEXT

# How did your *identity* shape this story?

*No story happens in a vacuum. The lens you lived it through is part of the truth of it.*

ANY THAT APPLY

Race

Gender

Culture

Disability

Military life

Family role

Faith

Trauma history

Socioeconomic background

*Context matters. Your story didn't happen in a vacuum.*

SPACE FOR WRITING

4

WHO NEEDS THIS STORY?

## Who might *benefit* from hearing this story?

*Your story may be someone else's lifeline — the language they've been searching for.*

THINK ABOUT

Someone navigating a similar challenge

Someone who feels alone

Someone who needs language for what they're carrying

Someone who needs to understand a system differently

Someone who needs to see resilience modeled

*Your story may be someone else's lifeline.*

SPACE FOR WRITING

## 5

## THE IMPACT OF YOUR STORY

# What *impact* could your story have if shared with intention?

*Impact doesn't require volume — only intention. A single true sentence can shift a room, a policy, a life.*

COULD IT

Reduce stigma?

Build connection?

Shift understanding?

Challenge assumptions?

Influence a system?

Empower someone else?

Create space for truth?

*Impact doesn't require volume — only intention.*

SPACE FOR WRITING

## MINI STORYTELLING FRAMEWORK

# The *Unmuted* Narrative Framework

*Use this to shape your story when you're ready — not before.*

**A**

## Opening

*What moment or truth brings us into the story?*

Anchor the listener in a scene, a sensation, or a single true sentence.

**B**

## Tension

*What challenge, stigma, or barrier did you face?*

Name the friction honestly — the part most people are trained to skip.

**C**

## Turning Point

*What shifted? What changed your understanding?*

The hinge. The moment the story stopped happening *to* you and started moving *through* you.

**D**

## Insight

*What did you learn? What truth emerged?*

The wisdom you now carry — the thing you know because you lived it.

**E**

## Ongoing Journey

*How does this story continue to shape you today?*

Story is not static. Share where you are still learning, still healing, still becoming.





## CLOSING REFLECTION

*You don't have to tell your story today.*

*You don't have to tell it all at once.*

*You don't have to tell it publicly.*



*But you deserve to honor it.*

*You deserve to name it.*

*You deserve to understand its power.*

*Your story is not just personal —  
it is a catalyst.*